



S-38

- 1889** Igor Sikorsky is born in Kiev, Ukraine.
1909 Sikorsky studies engineering in Paris.
1912 The S-6 design wins the Moscow Aircraft Competition.
1919 Sikorsky emigrates to the USA.
1923 The Sikorsky Aero Engineering Corp is established.
1928 The twin-engined amphibious aircraft the S-38 is launched.
1929 Sikorsky's company becomes part of the United Aircraft and Transport Co.
1940 The VS-300 is launched.



R-4

- 1943** Production begins on the R-4, the world's first mass-produced helicopter.
1944 The first helicopter rescue is made by the R-4, evacuating wounded soldiers from Burma during World War II.
1946 The S-51 is the first helicopter to fly in the Antarctic.
1949 The first flight of the S-55, which has a nose-mounted engine, takes place. The S-55 is used in the Korean War.
1951 The S-58, one of the last piston-powered helicopters, enters service.



S-61 Sea King

- 1953** The S-56 is the first heavy-lift twin-engined helicopter by Sikorsky.
1959 The twin-turbine S-61 Sea King is launched.
1962 The S-61L enters commercial service with Los Angeles Airway.
1965 The S-61W enters offshore oil support service.
1967 The CH-53 arrives in Vietnam.
1972 Sikorsky dies in Connecticut, USA.
1973 The first flight of the experimental S-69 coaxial rotor helicopter takes place.



Black Hawk

- 1976** Black Hawk wins a US Army competition and enters service in 1979.
1977 The first flight of the S-76 takes place.
1980 The heavy-lift CH-53E enters service.
1985 The SH-60B Seahawk is deployed by the US Navy.
1988 MH-60, Special Operations variant of Black Hawk developed.
2004 The S-92 is launched as a successor to the S-61.
2010 The experimental helicopter X2 becomes the fastest helicopter to date.

had attempted to develop suitable aircraft in the 1950s. However, it was the lightweight but powerful turbine engine that made this a reality. The skeletal S-64 Skycrane, with its unusual, rearward-facing operator position, found widespread use with the US Army during the Vietnam War, recovering fallen aircraft. Surplus military S-64s and new examples built by Erikson Air-Crane remain in service today fighting wildfires, harvesting lumber, and in heavy-lift construction around the world.

Alongside the Skycrane, Sikorsky developed the heavy-lift S-65 with an unobstructed cabin and tail ramp. As the CH-53, this powerful helicopter was active during the Vietnam War. Adding a third engine in 1974 created the even more powerful CH-53E. This has now developed into the larger CH-53K, able to carry loads of 35,053 lb (15,900 kg) and is due to enter service with the Marines in 2018.

Igor Sikorsky passed away in 1972 at the age of 83, having continued work almost up to his death. He left not just a legacy but a talented team to continue driving the company forward. In the year of his death, they submitted the S-70 design in a US Army utility helicopter competition. In 1976 the aircraft was selected and entered production as the Black Hawk. Since then more than 2,100 versions have been built and the type is still in production. In the same year the company also introduced the S-76, its first helicopter designed purely for civilian use.

Sikorsky continues to experiment with new high-speed helicopter designs. In 2010 test flights of the X2, with its coaxial rotor, reached speeds of 288 mph (463 km/h).

Today Sikorsky has grown far beyond its roots with manufacturing, test, and completion facilities now in

Florida, Pennsylvania, Texas, and Poland. The Black Hawk, S-76 and S-92 continue in production, the CH-53K is nearing completion, and construction has begun on its S-97 Raider, using technology from the X2 to reach speeds of up to 276 mph (444 km/h). Igor's legacy continues.

Sikorsky S-64F Skycrane

This Italian-owned S-64 collects water from the sea to be used for aerial firefighting. The heavy-lift helicopter can refill its 2,200-gallon (10,000-liter) tank in under 45 seconds.

